

BTS Star RM Shows His Art Collection at a Museum

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RM, the leader of the **K-pop** band BTS, is sharing art from his own **collection** at a **museum** for the first time. The San Francisco **Museum** of Modern Art is packed with fans who want to see it.

The show has more than 170 artworks. Most belong to RM, and many are by Korean artists. The **museum's** gift shop got ready with more **souvenirs** than ever before.

RM, whose real name is Kim Nam-joon, is 32. He started visiting **museums** and collecting art nearly 10 years ago. Some of his songs were inspired by art. Fans even made up a word, "Namjooning," for doing the things he loves.

RM said he picked art that really moved him and still has something to say today.

Two fans, Bre Walker and Joi Karra, spotted seven carved wooden ducks and wondered if they stood for the seven members of BTS. Walker said it was her first time ever in an art **museum**. "I'll be back," she said.

Word Treasure

K-pop -- Popular music from South Korea.

collection -- A group of things someone has gathered over time.

souvenirs -- Things people buy to remember a place or event.

museum -- A building where people can see art or other important objects.

Background you need

Art museums show paintings and sculptures so people can enjoy and learn from them.

BTS is a K-pop group from South Korea with seven members and millions of fans around the world.

Break it down

WHO: RM, the leader of the K-pop band BTS, and his fans

WHAT: RM is showing art from his own collection for the first time

WHERE: The San Francisco Museum of Modern Art

WHY: RM loves art and chose works that really moved him

Why it matters

It shows that a favorite singer can inspire fans to try new things, like visiting an art museum.

Test what you remember

1. Who is RM?

- ☐ (A) A tennis player
- ☐ (B) A museum director
- ☐ (C) A painter from Zambia
- ☐ (D) The leader of BTS

2. Where is RM's art being shown?

- ☐ (A) A school in Korea
- ☐ (B) The San Francisco Museum of Modern Art
- ☐ (C) A mall in Las Vegas
- ☐ (D) The White House

3. How many artworks are in the show?

- ☐ (A) Over 1,000
- ☐ (B) More than 170
- ☐ (C) Exactly 32
- ☐ (D) About 7

4. What is RM's real name?

- ☐ (A) Bre Walker
- ☐ (B) Mark Rothko
- ☐ (C) Kim Nam-joon
- ☐ (D) Joi Karra

5. What did fans think the seven wooden ducks stood for?

- ☐ (A) Seven songs
- ☐ (B) Seven museums
- ☐ (C) The seven members of BTS
- ☐ (D) Seven days

6. What did Bre Walker say after visiting?

- ☐ (A) I'll be back
- ☐ (B) I want a refund
- ☐ (C) I didn't like it
- ☐ (D) It was too crowded

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: B 3: B 4: C 5: C 6: A

Questions to think about

1. RM: Says he picked art that really moved him and still has something to say today.
2. Fan Bre Walker: Says it was her first time in an art museum and she will be back.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):